

Buttons

Design guidelines · Parent Guidance · Updated October 1, 2026

Every action button in the prototype comes from a single system, built from the most repeated button in the original design (the `UnifiedCard` one: teal, 8px, Poppins semibold 14px, teal dark on hover) and implemented in the `Button.tsx` component (section 2.4).

2.1 Styles

Style	Look	When
Primary	<code>pg-teal</code> background, white text; <code>pg-teal-dark</code> on hover	The main action of the section: "View course", "Book a session", "Submit question"
Secondary	White background, 1px <code>pg-teal</code> border, <code>pg-teal-dark</code> text; <code>pg-tint</code> background on hover	Supporting action next to a Primary ("Cancel", "View details")
Tertiary	<code>pg-teal-dark</code> text only, underlined on hover	Low-priority actions: "See more", "Skip"
Inverse	White background, <code>pg-navy</code> text; <code>pg-cream</code> on hover	Main action on navy, teal or sage backgrounds
Inverse secondary	<code>white/5</code> background, <code>white/20</code> border, white text; <code>white/10</code> on hover	Supporting action on dark backgrounds

One Primary per section. If there are more actions, they become Secondary or Tertiary.

There are no navy or sage buttons: navy is the color of text and navigation, not of action. That way users learn that teal means "I can click this".

On a **sage** background (banners such as "Not sure which resource is right for you?") the main action is **Inverse**: teal on sage is barely visible.

2.2 Sizes

Size	Height	Padding	Text	When
S	36px	<code>px-4</code>	14px / 600	Dense UI: toolbars, pagination, "Register" in event rows. On mobile, only if the button is full width
M	44px	<code>px-5</code>	14px / 600	Default

Size	Height	Padding	Text	When
L	52px	px-7	16px / 600	Hero CTAs and key screens on mobile

- `rounded-pg-md` radius (8px) on every size.
- The **pill** shape (`rounded-full`) is reserved for chips, badges, filters and the search bar. Not for action buttons.
- Optional icon on the right (`→` arrow or 16px lucide icon) with `gap-2` . If the icon is decorative, it gets `aria-hidden="true"` .
- `w-full` only inside cards or on mobile.

2.3 States

State	Primary	Secondary
Default	<code>bg-pg-teal text-white</code>	<code>bg-white border-pg-teal text-pg-teal-dark</code>
Hover	<code>bg-pg-teal-dark</code>	<code>bg-pg-tint</code>
Pressed	<code>scale 0.97</code> (motion <code>whileTap</code>)	same
Focus	2px <code>pg-teal-dark</code> ring with a 2px offset	same
Loading	16px spinner + "Sending...", <code>aria-busy="true"</code> , no clicks	same
Disabled	<code>bg-pg-line text-pg-slate</code> , <code>not-allowed</code> cursor	<code>border-pg-line text-pg-slate</code>

Visible focus is applied globally in `src/styles/accessibility.css` : every link, button or field shows a 2px teal dark ring with a white halo when navigating with the keyboard, on light and dark backgrounds. New components don't need to add focus classes.

2.4 Component

The prototype's buttons use `src/app/components/Button.tsx` :

Component	For	Example
<code><Button></code>	Actions (submit, open, download)	<code><Button variant="secondary" size="s" onClick={...}>Today</Button></code>
<code><ButtonLink></code>	Navigation inside the app (<code>react-router</code>)	<code><ButtonLink to="/ask-a-therapist">View Answer</ButtonLink></code>
<code><ButtonAnchor></code>	External links, <code>mailto:</code> , <code>tel:</code> , <code>sms:</code> and <code>#</code> anchors	<code><ButtonAnchor href="tel:988" variant="inverse" size="l">Call 988</ButtonAnchor></code>
<code>buttonClass()</code>	Just the classes, for elements that can't use the components	<code>className={buttonClass({ variant: "secondary" })}</code>

- Props: `variant` (`primary` by default, `secondary`, `tertiary`, `inverse`, `inverse-secondary`) and `size` (`s`, `m` by default, `l`). `<Button>` also accepts `loading` .
- They all have `whileTap={{ scale: 0.97 }}` and no `whileHover` scaling; hover changes color only.
- `className` is for layout (`w-full`, `mt-4`, `shrink-0`), not for changing colors, radii or sizes.
- Exception: the "Search" button inside a pill-shaped search bar may use `rounded-full`, because it is part of the bar.
- In newsletters, the button sits **inside** the input box (with `p-1.5` and `gap-2`), not glued to its edge.

Controls that are not action buttons

These elements have their own style and do **not** use `<Button>` :

Control	Style
Filter chips	<code>rounded-full text-xs font-medium px-4 py-2</code> ; active <code>bg-pg-navy text-white</code> , inactive <code>bg-pg-cream-dark text-pg-slate</code> , with <code>aria-pressed</code>
"Featured" (sort) menu	<code>rounded-pg-md bg-pg-cream-dark text-xs font-medium px-4 py-2.5</code> , 14px lucide <code>ListFilter</code> + <code>ChevronDown</code> icons, centered with the label
Segmented control (Month/List, Day/Week/Month)	<code>bg-pg-tint-soft</code> container; active option is white with <code>shadow-pg-card</code> and <code>aria-pressed</code>
Numeric pagination	36–44px squares; current page in navy or teal; Prev/Next as <code><Button variant="secondary" size="s"></code>
Icon-only buttons	36–44px, <code>rounded-pg-md</code> , <code>aria-label</code> required (calendar arrows, close, menu)

2.5 Accessibility

- Use `<button>` for actions and `<a>` for navigation. Never `<div onClick>` .
- Minimum touch area of **44×44px** on mobile (size M or L).
- External links (`target="_blank"`) must say so: an external-link icon + hidden text "(opens in a new tab)".
- Icon-only buttons get an `aria-label` ("Close", "Menu").
- Disabled: explain why with nearby helper text if it isn't obvious.
- On the **Get Help** page (crisis lines), call/text buttons use `<a href="tel:...">` and `<a href="sms:...">` in size L, so they are easy to tap in a moment of stress.

2.6 Do / Don't

Do

- One Primary per section, in teal.
- Short labels that start with a verb: "View course", "Book a session".
- The same size for every button in a row.

Don't

- Navy, sage or mist buttons.
- Mixing pill and rectangular buttons on the same screen.
- `whileHover` scaling above 1.02 on buttons: it feels unstable.
- Button text at 10–11px.